Data Analytics Career Roadmap (India, 0-8 years)

A comprehensive guide to building your data analytics career in India - from foundational skills to leadership roles. This roadmap covers the essential skills, projects, and salary expectations at each career stage over an 8-year journey.

Career Progression Overview

Phase 0: Foundations (0-6 months)

Master Excel, SQL, Python basics, statistics fundamentals, and visualization tools

Phase 1: Analyst Productivity (6-12 months)

Develop KPI trees, metric definitions, and data modeling skills

Phase 2: Experimentation (1-2 years)

Learn A/B testing, forecasting, and automation techniques

Phase 3: Senior Analyst (2-3 years)

Own end-to-end analysis and stakeholder management

Phase 4: Analytics Lead (3-5 years)

Develop ELT pipelines, semantic layers, and governance frameworks

Phase 5: Head/Manager (5-8 years)

Drive organizational strategy, vendor selection, and team leadership

Phase 0: Foundations (0-6 months)

Technical Skills

- Excel (pivot, LOOKUP/XLOOKUP, Power Query)
- SQL basics (joins, windows)
- Python fundamentals (pandas)
- Statistics: probability, sampling, hypothesis tests
- Visualization: Power BI/Tableau fundamentals

Expected Outputs

- 2 dashboards
- 1 analysis notebook
- ATS-optimized resume

Project Ideas

- Sales dashboard
- Admissions funnel
- Churn EDA + insights

Phase 1: Analyst Productivity & Impact (6-12 months)

KPI Trees & Metrics

Develop structured KPI hierarchies and precise metric definitions

Master data modeling concepts (star/snowflake schemas)

Advanced Visualization

DAX/Power Query or Tableau Calculations

Parameters, drill-through capabilities, row-level security

SQL for Analytics

Common Table Expressions (CTEs)

Window functions

Time-series aggregations

Expected Output: Decision-first dashboards with stakeholder walkthroughs (Loom)

Project Ideas: Marketing ROI analysis, Lead-to-enrollment conversion dashboard, Operations SLA dashboard

Phase 2: Experimentation & Forecasting (1-2 years)

Key Skills to Develop

- A/B testing fundamentals and power analysis
- CUPED (Controlled-experiment Using Pre-Experiment Data) introduction
- Forecasting techniques (Prophet/ARIMA/ETS)
- Understanding seasonality & holiday effects
- Automation: scheduled refresh, email alerts
- Introduction to data contracts

Expected Output: Experiment analysis + forecasting case study

Phase 3: Senior Analyst Scope (2-3 years)

Problem Framing

Define business problems clearly and structure analytical approaches

Analysis

Execute comprehensive data analysis with statistical rigor

Decision

Drive data-informed decisions with clear recommendations

Follow-up

Track outcomes and iterate on solutions

At this stage, you'll also develop crucial skills in stakeholder management, data storytelling, and decision memo writing. You'll implement data quality monitors, ensure SLA adherence, and conduct incident postmortems.

Expected Output: Portfolio of 2-3 high-impact analyses with documented business outcomes

Phase 4: Analytics Lead / Analytics Engineer (3-5 years)

Technical Leadership

- dbt basics and ELT pipeline development
- Semantic layers implementation
- Metric stores design and management

Governance & Mentorship

- Create and maintain KPI dictionary
- Establish definition review processes
- Implement approval workflows
- Mentor junior analysts

Expected Output: Analytics architecture documentation + roadmap; evidence of successful junior analyst mentoring

Phase 5: Head/Manager – Analytics (5-8 years)

Organizational Strategy

- Foster experimentation culture
- Implement KPI tree governance
- Develop self-serve analytics capabilities

Resource Management

- Vendor selection and management
- Budget planning and allocation
- Design and conduct hiring processes

Expected Output: Quarterly analytics strategy with measurable outcomes

What to Learn: Topic-wise Skills

Excel/BI

Power Query, DAX/Tableau Calculations, parameters, row-level security, visualization best practices

SQL

Joins, window functions, date/time handling, performance optimization, CTEs & subqueries

Python

pandas, numpy, plotly; basic statistics packages; simple automation scripts

Stats/Experimentation

Hypothesis testing, A/B testing fundamentals, introduction to CUPED

Modeling/Forecasting

Regression, basic classification, ARIMA/Prophet

Data Modeling

Star/snowflake schemas, SCD basics; metric definitions & ownership

More Essential Skills

Automation

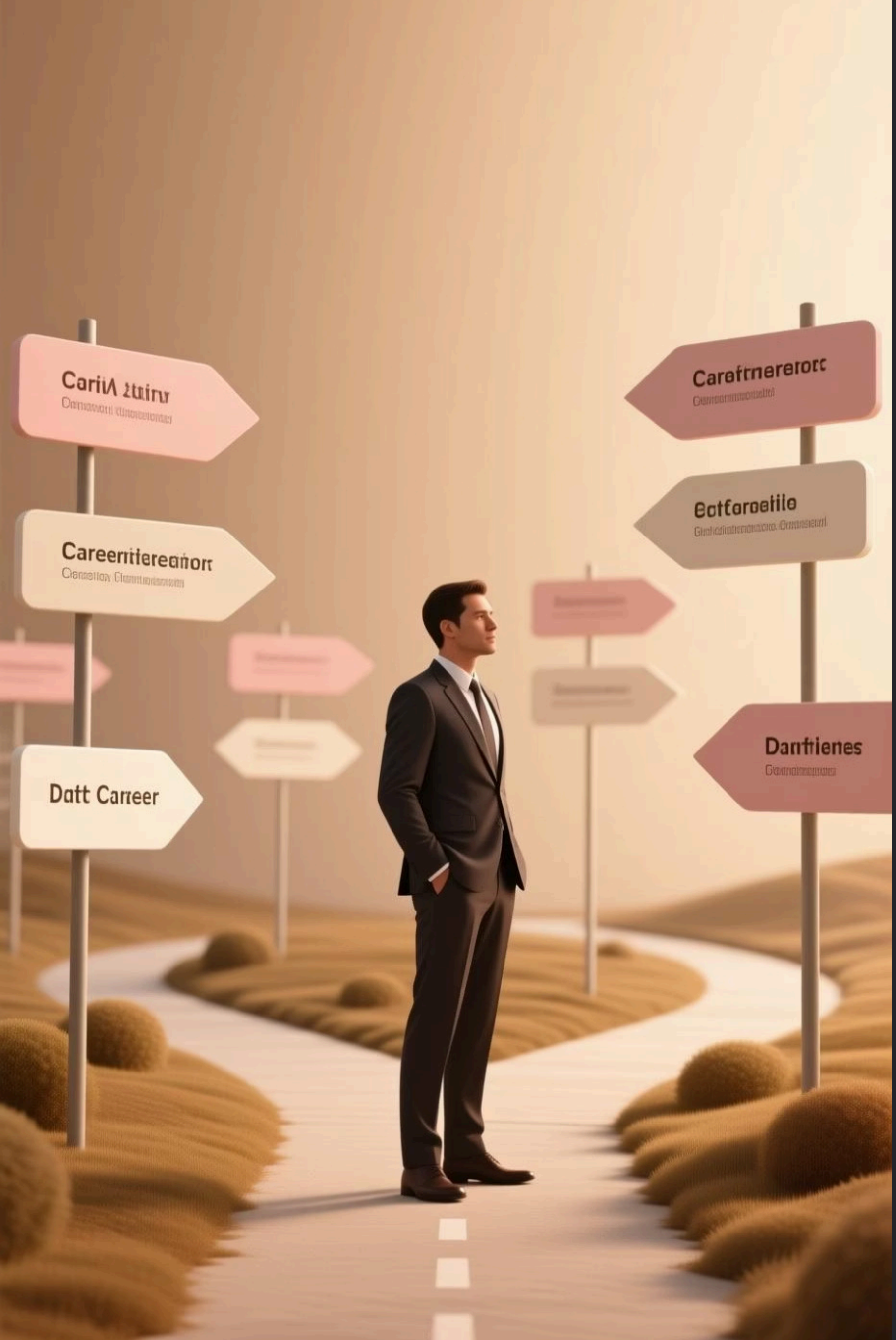
- Refresh schedules
- Alerting mechanisms
- SLA monitoring
- Data contracts (introduction)

Storytelling

- Decision memos
- Data narratives
- Stakeholder workshops
- Executive presentations

Project Ideas

- Admissions funnel analysis
- Cohort retention dashboard
- Pricing impact study
- Sales forecasting model
- SLA tracking system
- Campaign ROI analysis



Career Pivot Options (After ~3 Years)

Senior Analyst → Analytics Lead/Manager

Focus on strategy, governance, and experimentation frameworks

Analyst → Data Scientist

Deepen machine learning and statistical skills; master causal inference; learn model productionization

Analyst → Analytics Engineer

Specialize in dbt/ELT pipelines, semantic layers, and versioned metrics

Analyst → Product Analyst

Focus on experimentation platforms, metric design, and decision science

12-Week Upskill Plan

1. **Weeks 1-3**

   Advanced SQL + data modeling; KPI dictionary development

2. **Weeks 4-6**

   Experimentation techniques (A/B testing, CUPED) + case study

3. **Weeks 7-9**

   Forecasting methodologies + automation (schedules/alerts)

4. **Weeks 10-12**

   dbt + semantic layer; stakeholder communication; decision memo writing

This intensive 12-week plan helps you rapidly develop the skills needed to advance to the next level in your analytics career. Each phase builds on the previous one, creating a comprehensive skill set.

Weekly Study Plan (Weeks 1-6)

Week	Focus	Goals	Output
1	Excel/SQL refresh	Master queries & joins	SQL challenge + Excel mini-case
2	EDA & Visualization	Create best-practice dashboards	One clean dashboard
3	KPIs & modeling	Develop KPI tree, metrics	KPI specification document
4	Advanced BI	Learn DAX/Tableau Calculations, RLS	Interactive dashboard
5	SQL windows/time	Master timeseries aggregation, performance	SQL notebook
6	A/B basics	Understand power & CUPED (intro)	Experiment plan

Weekly Study Plan (Weeks 7-12)

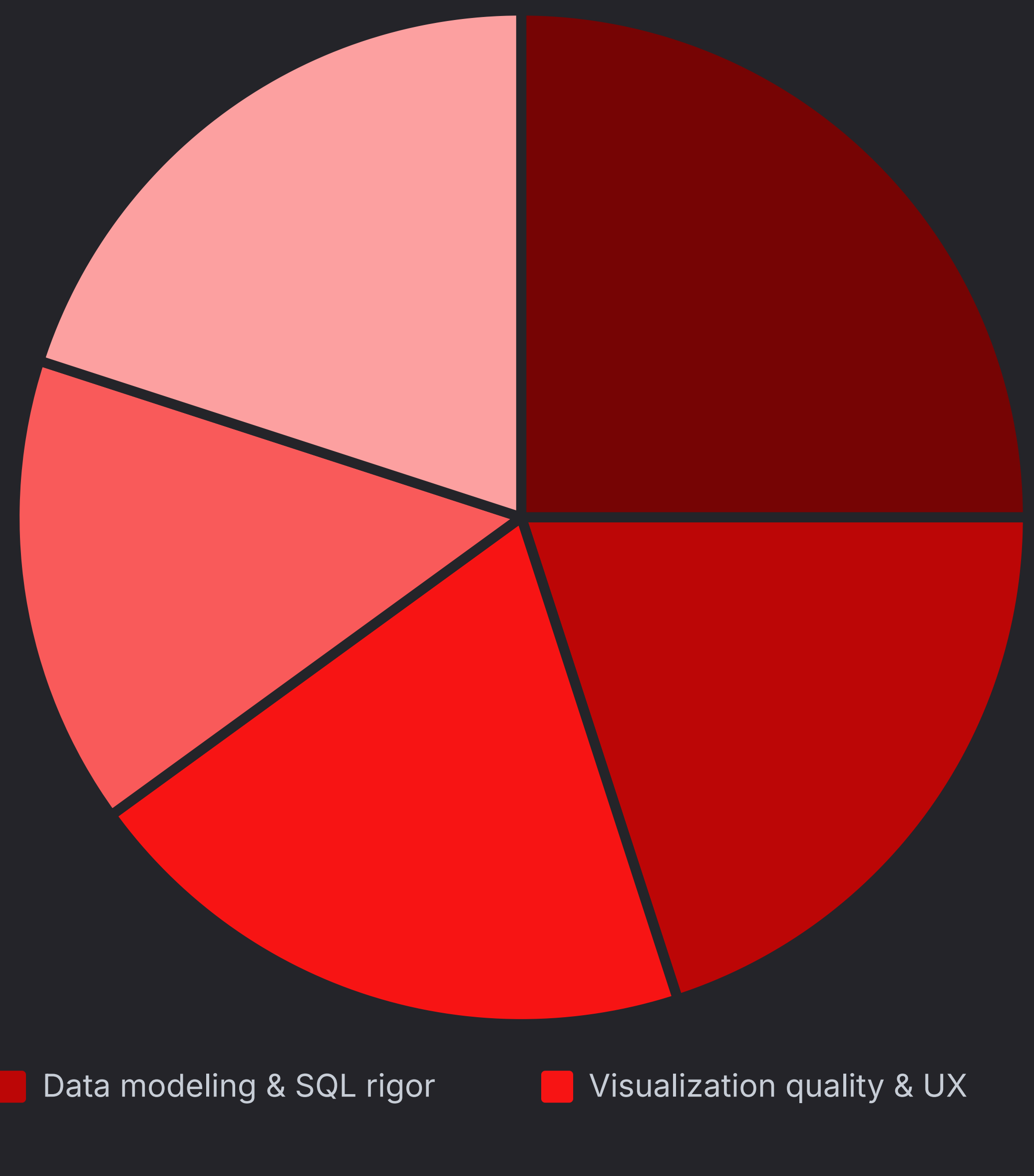
Week	Focus	Goals	Output
7	Forecasting	Master seasonality/holidays analysis	Forecast notebook
8	Automation	Implement schedules/alerts	Refresh pipeline
9	Storytelling	Create decision-first communications	Decision memo
10	dbt basics	Learn ELT, tests	dbt mini-project
11	Semantic layer	Define metric names/owners	Metric specification
12	Capstone	Complete end-to-end case	Case study + Loom presentation

Following this structured weekly plan ensures you build skills systematically, with concrete outputs that demonstrate your growing expertise.

Portfolio Checklist

1. 3-5 dashboards (Power BI/Tableau) + 1-2 notebooks
2. KPI dictionary & decision memos
3. SQL repository with window/date queries
4. Automation demo (scheduled refresh/alerts)
5. ATS-optimized resume + LinkedIn featured work

Portfolio Evaluation Rubric



Your portfolio will be evaluated on these five key dimensions, with the highest weight given to demonstrating business impact and decision support. Communication skills and technical rigor are also heavily weighted.

India Salary Ranges by Experience (LPA)

5-9L

0-1 years

Entry-level analysts in Bengaluru and Delhi NCR can expect ₹5-9 LPA

7-12L

1-2 years

With 1-2 years experience, salaries range from ₹6-12 LPA across major cities

7-14L

2-3 years

Senior analysts with 2-3 years experience can earn ₹7-14 LPA

10-22L

3-5 years

Analytics leads with 3-5 years experience command ₹10-22 LPA

14-30L

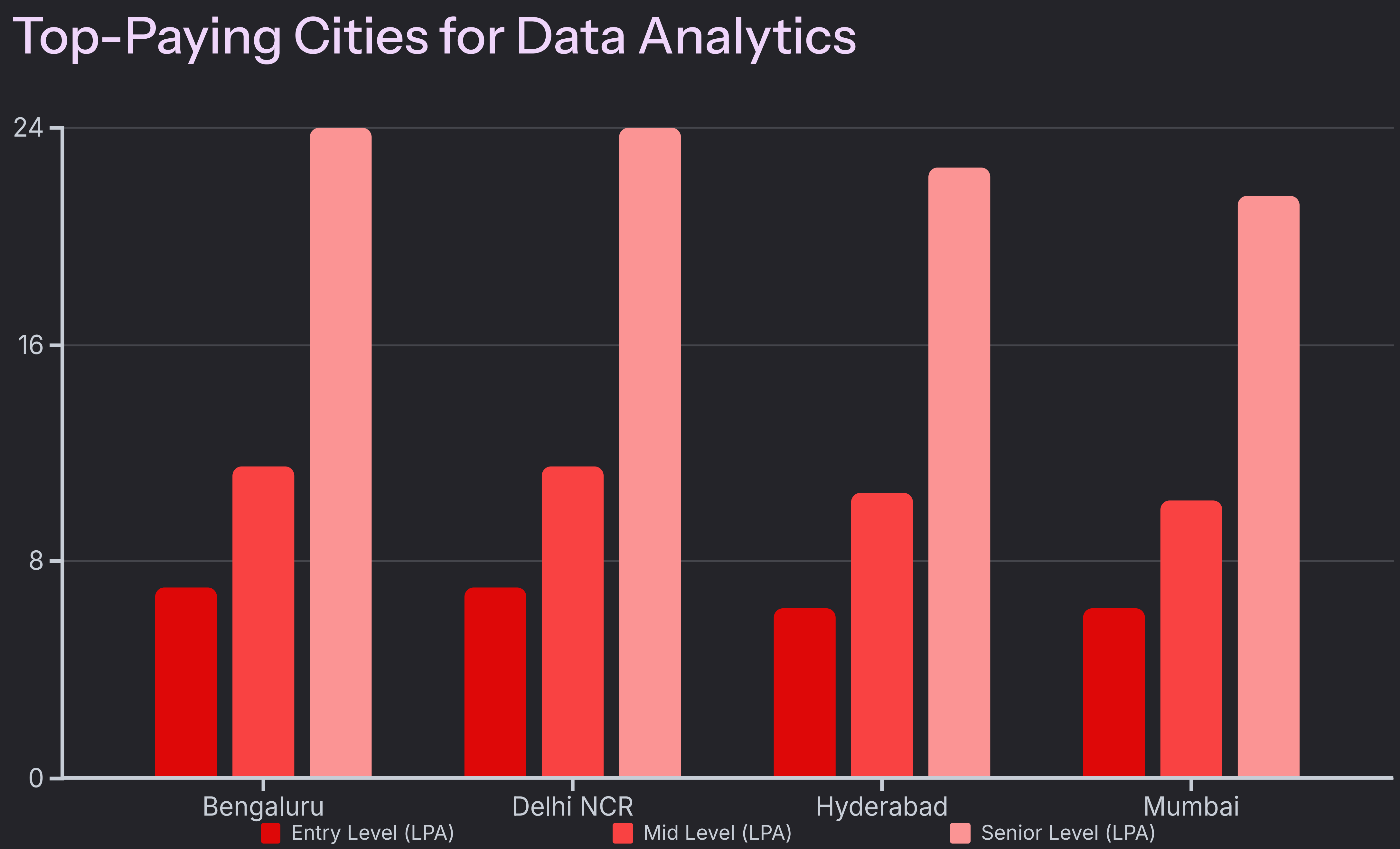
5-8 years

Analytics managers with 5-8 years experience earn ₹14-30 LPA

Note: Ranges are indicative and vary by role scope, skills, and market timing.

City-wise Salary Comparison (India)

City	0-1 yrs	1-2 yrs	2-3 yrs	3-5 yrs	5-8 yrs
Bengaluru	5-9 L	7-11 L	9-14 L	13-22 L	18-30 L
Delhi NCR	5-9 L	8-12 L	9-14 L	13-22 L	18-30 L
Hyderabad	4.5-8 L	7-11 L	8-13 L	12-20 L	17-28 L
Mumbai	4.5-8 L	6.5-10 L	8-12.5 L	12-19 L	16-27 L
Pune	4.5-8 L	6.5-10 L	8-12 L	11-18 L	15-26 L
Chennai	4-7.5 L	6-9.5 L	7-11 L	10-17 L	14-24 L



Bengaluru and Delhi NCR consistently offer the highest compensation across all experience levels, with Hyderabad following closely behind. Entry level represents 0-1 years, Mid level is 2-3 years, and Senior level is 5-8 years experience.

Your Data Analytics Journey Starts Now

Start With Foundations

Master the core technical skills in Excel, SQL, and visualization tools

Build Your Portfolio

Create impactful projects that demonstrate business value

Follow The Roadmap

Use this structured approach to advance your career systematically

This roadmap provides a clear path from entry-level analyst to analytics leadership over an 8-year journey. By following this structured approach and consistently building your skills and portfolio, you can navigate your data analytics career in India with confidence.

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